FDE capacity: what to commit to for next half

To: FDE leadership · **From:** Jaeger Wells · **Date:** 24 October 2026
Model: live dashboard · code · *Data are made up for a demo; none of it is Anthropic data.*

Bottom line

FDE requests are growing about 6% a month (13 a month now, ~50 by September 2028), and the current plan covers about **61%** of the demand we take on. None of the plans below has better than even odds of 90% coverage next half (April–September 2027). I recommend a **blended capacity plan with a prioritization rule, committed at P80**, and treating productization as a bet to measure before we scale it.

What the model says

- **Hiring alone is too slow.** Time to fill plus ramp is about five months. At today's 2.3 hires a month there is an 8% chance of averaging 90% coverage next half; at 6 a month it is still only 41%.
- **Saying no to some Greenfield work delivers more.** Taking on 80% of fit Greenfield requests starts **300 engagements instead of 285** over 24 months, for the same cost. Greenfield work is about three times the effort of pattern-based work, and partners can't take it.
- **Productization is unproven, not wrong.** Raising harvest time from 7% to 12% roughly breaks even (it wins in 16% of paired trials). The result hinges on one unmeasured number, the share of an engagement reusable assets can cover; across its plausible range it swings from −14 to +41 engagements.
- **Demand is the biggest uncertainty.** Moving the growth assumption from its P10 to its P90 swings next half's coverage from 70% to 50%, more than any supply input.

Plan (Apr–Sep 2027)	Coverage P50 (P10–P90)	Chance ≥ 80%	Engagements, 24 mo	Cost, 24 mo
Current plan	61% (43–88%)	17%	285	$46.4m
Hire-heavy (4.6 hires/mo)	76% (55–108%)	43%	374	$63.0m
Prioritize (80% Greenfield intake)	73% (53–105%)	37%	300	$46.6m
Blended (3.5 hires/mo, 45 partner wks, 80% Greenfield)	**88% (63–127%)**	**65%**	**373**	**$59.7m**

Recommendation

1. **Adopt the Blended plan:** 3.5 hires a month, 45 partner weeks a month, and take on 80% of fit Greenfield requests. It delivers about as many engagements as Hire-heavy for $3.3m less, at a lower cost per engagement than today ($160k vs $163k).
2. **Commit at P80, not the median.** Under Blended we can commit to **72% coverage** next half (vs 49% today), and set SOW dates at P80: a Greenfield build with 2 FDEs goes live in 136 days; a third FDE cuts that to 106 days and raises the chance of being live by day 90 from 37% to 62%.
3. **Open the next reqs in APAC,** where FDE coverage is about 40% against about 58% in AMER and EMEA.
4. **Hold harvest time at 7–9% and measure the reuse ceiling for two quarters**: hours saved per pattern-based engagement once the library passes 60 assets, and whether harvest hours come from bench time or delivery. **Decision rule, agreed now:** if assets cover ≥ 40% of pattern-based effort, move harvest to 12%.
5. **Validate the demand forecast before locking the hiring plan;** it moves the answer most.

Method: an 18-month synthetic history in DuckDB, calibrated through SQL views into a 24-month driver model, run as 2,000 Monte Carlo trials. Every input, its source and its range are on the dashboard's Data & definitions page.